

PALL MALL GAZETTE

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THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

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The Pall Mall Gazette was a London evening newspaper founded in 1865. It became famous under editor W.T. Stead, who took charge in 1883. Stead made the paper easier to read by using shorter paragraphs, large headlines, maps, and pictures. He believed newspapers should campaign for social change.

His most famous investigation exposed child prostitution in London. To prove how easily children could be bought, Stead arranged to buy a 13-year-old girl with the help of the Salvation Army. The story shocked the public and helped Parliament raise the age of consent from 13 to 16. However, Stead was sent to prison for three months because of his actions. This investigation is now seen as one of the first examples of investigative journalism.

The also campaigned for better housing and a stronger navy. Although it became very influential, its sales later fell, and it merged with the Evening Standard in 1923.

THE QUEEN'S SECLUSION.

A LITTLE paragraph appeared in the newspapers lately, to revive a hope which was to have been fulfilled to-day, and has not. "We are informed that Her MAJESTY the QUEEN will open Parliament in person next session:" this was the little paragraph—printed, too, in that authoritative large type which carries conviction straight into the minds of most newspaper readers. But somehow the herald who brought such good tidings from Court was little credited. The trumpet sounded—that we all heard; but no confirming echo answered it—not even in those hollow places in our own hearts where dwells the hope of what we much desire. The most timid inquirer hesitated to believe; and he whose faith in editorial announcements had hitherto been complete, found himself disturbed by a strangely courageous scepticism. Was the announcement authorized at all by any one? Had we not been told of journalists and politicians who endeavoured to achieve what they wished by declaring it already certain? These questions were asked by many people. The answer to the first one is that the QUEEN never at any moment intended to open Parliament this session—(here is our own authoritative large type to prove it)—and to the other, that if the trick was played, it was a trick which only a very few philosophers can muster morality enough to condemn. There may be some politicians of the fermentative platform kind who secretly rejoice that (if tried) it did not succeed, but they are not philosophers.